

Notes and Queries

[The editors will welcome as contributions to this section of the *California Folklore Quarterly* either small items of traditional materials or inquiries designed to elicit information about such materials. In general, discussion of the materials here offered will be brief. Records of facts likely to be lost or overlooked, and inquiries which our readers may be able to answer—such items will be the typical ones.]

Festivals and Carnivals.—Recent inquiries in *American Notes and Queries* (I, 21, 77) about traditional festivals and carnivals in the United States raise the question of how many such festivals are celebrated annually, or periodically, in the state of California and adjoining states? Professor Wayland D. Hand, in his article on “California Miners’ Folklore” in the *Quarterly* (I, 151, n. 47) gave a reasonably complete list of festivals connected with mining in the state. Could not similar lists be compiled for festivals connected with other industries and with agriculture? If the response to this query warrants, the editors will be glad to print an annual directory of festivals to supplement that in the *California State Guide*, compiled by the Federal Writers’ Project, which is neither complete nor accurate.—THE EDITORS.

A Horse in the Lode.—Can anyone supply me with references to and a possible interpretation of the miners’ phrase, “a horse in the lode,” which is supposed to refer to a mass of unproductive ground in the middle of a mineral lode. Likewise, I should like to know more about the saying, “Black Jack rides a good horse,” i.e., zinc ore gives good promise of copper. These are Cornish expressions occurring in Robert Hunt’s *Popular Romances of the West of England* (London, 1865), I, 214. Might not they have been brought to the mines of California and other western states by the “Cousin Jacks” like so much other Cornish miners’ lore?

University of California, Los Angeles

WAYLAND D. HAND

The Wild Girl of the Santa Barbara Channel Islands.—I wonder if any of the readers of *California Folklore Quarterly* has heard versions of the following or similar story of the wild girl of the Santa Barbara Channel Islands? It was first told to me by Joseph Henniger, Los Angeles artist, as we were driving along the coast highway between Ventura and Santa

Barbara, while one of the islands was in full view. That was in January, 1942. The present version was taken down stenographically from a second account given by Mr. Henniger in November. The story is so typical of the primitive animal-fed-child stories, of which the legends of Zeus and of Romulus and Remus are famous examples, that it deserves the attention of folklorists everywhere.

The man who told this story was just loaded full of California folklore. He knew California history as well as anyone with whom I have come in contact. He was telling us one night that there was a very curious story told about a wild girl who was found here in California. All of this was apropos of the stories of children raised by wolves in India.

A group of sportsmen living up at Santa Barbara decided to go over to hunt wild goats on one of the islands off the coast. No one had gone to this island for a number of years because it was very hard to reach. These men finally made the island, anchored the boat offshore, and went ashore in a small boat. They hunted for the day and in returning to the boat came across this curious creature who was running along the beach stark naked and tore up the side of the mountain as fast as a goat could go. One of the men asked the fellows if they had noticed this thing running along the beach; he would have sworn it was a young woman completely nude. The other fellows hadn't noticed it, but the man was so insistent that they climbed up the side of the mountain and found a cave and with their lights went in. They found this cave loaded full of bones—goats' bones, rabbits', etc. In the back of the cave they found this wild young girl. They tied her up and took her back to the boat and took her to the mainland. She couldn't speak any English. When they got to shore they put her in the hands of medical authorities who said she had been wild for several years. They delved back into the records of missing persons and [found that] in the year 1901 or 1902 a sailboat had set out from Santa Barbara with a man, his wife, and daughter a little over two. Several weeks later pieces of the boat were washed ashore but there were no signs of the bodies, and so these men concluded that what had happened was that this child had survived the storm. She had been old enough to walk and apparently had existed since that time on the island. She was removed to a hospital and the authorities did everything they could to cover up her predicament and hide her from the curious.

The man who told Henniger the story was named Waddie, a certified public accountant.

AUSTIN E. FIFE

Santa Ana, California

[EDITORIAL NOTE.—See an account of an actual event of this sort in *Life and Adventures of George Nidever* (Berkeley, California: University of California Press, 1937), pp. 81 ff.]

Don Luis Arguëllo and the Golden Doves.—Can you refer me to any reasonably accurate recital of a tale placed in the time of Don Luis Ar-